

HARDWARE DEVICE EMULATION

Emulating an entire computer is great and all but did you know that you can get software that emulates only the bits and pieces you want to?

Probably the most popular example we can mention is a virtual optical (CD / DVD) drive. It's not uncommon to find computers these days that don't have an optical disk drive — especially laptops. Even on computers that do have an optical drive it's quite common that one will encounter a CD / DVD image as an iso file.

Now you could go to the market, purchase a blank DVD disk, use a burning software to burn this image to a disk, then reinsert the disk in the drive to finally access its contents. Or, you could skip the wasted plastic and time, and just use a software that emulates an optical drive. Such software will read data from the iso file, but make it appear on your computer as an actual disk drive. Chances are you've probably heard of and used such a software before, given how often we offer iso files on the disks that come with the magazine.